

Kara Thurmond

Senior Frontend Developer | UI/UX-Focused

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Catskill, New York | 917-903-2784

Senior Frontend Developer with extensive experience building accessible, responsive, and user-focused web interfaces. Originally trained as a graphic designer, I bring a strong foundation in visual design, usability, and frontend implementation, combining technical expertise with a thoughtful approach to UI/UX. Experienced in delivering maintainable, production-ready solutions across custom applications, websites, and long-lived codebases.

CORE SKILLS

Front-End: HTML5, CSS/SCSS, Tailwind CSS, JavaScript, Alpine.js

Application / Web Stack: Laravel, Blade, Livewire

Tools & Workflow: Git/GitHub, Vite, Webpack, VS Code, PhpStorm

UI & Collaboration: Responsive UI implementation, component-based development, browser compatibility testing, Figma, Jira, Slack

WORK EXPERIENCE

Web Developer | Freelance/Contract

Catskill, NY | December 2023 - Present; October 2015 - November 2017

- + Develop responsive, accessible frontend experiences using HTML, CSS/SCSS, JavaScript, Tailwind CSS, and modern web platforms including WordPress, Shopify, and Squarespace.
- + Implement user interfaces from design concepts while ensuring usability, responsive behavior, and maintainable frontend code.
- + Handle full project lifecycle from requirements gathering and technical setup through deployment and ongoing support.
- + Work directly with clients to evaluate needs and balance design vision with technical requirements

Senior Front-End Developer

Lead Marvels, Inc | Fishkill, NY | November 2017 - December 2023

- + Built 130+ websites in Laravel using Tailwind CSS and Alpine.js with focus on reusable components and maintainability
- + Modernized 20+ legacy websites by converting from Bootstrap/jQuery to Tailwind/Alpine, improving performance and maintainability
- + Developed component libraries and landing page pattern systems to increase team efficiency and ensure design consistency
- + Wrote code from Figma, Adobe XD, and Photoshop prototypes with high attention to accessibility and detail
- + Collaborated in Agile team environment using Jira for project management and GitHub for version control
- + Worked cross-functionally with designers, backend developers, and project managers

Production Director/Website E-commerce Manager

Modern Farmer Magazine | Hudson, NY | November 2012 - October 2015

- + Maintained WordPress website and WooCommerce e-commerce platform, ensuring seamless user experience
- + Prepared 140-page quarterly magazine for print production including all artwork preparation and Photoshop editing
- + Managed both digital and print workflows, demonstrating versatility across mediums

Freelance Web Developer/Graphic Designer

Independent | January 2004 - November 2012

- + Built and maintained custom websites for diverse clients, including NYU, Arabella Advisors, PR Newsire
- + Conceptualized and designed comprehensive branding packages and print collateral
- + Designed and implemented HTML email marketing campaigns

EDUCATION

BA in Philosophy | Mary Washington University | Fredericksburg, VA

DESIGN + FRONTEND PERSPECTIVE

My background in graphic design informs my frontend work with a strong understanding of visual hierarchy, usability, and design systems. I combine technical expertise with thoughtful UI decisions to create accessible, responsive web applications and experiences.